

Homeschooling: for or against?

1. Complete the statements so that they are true for you.

- When I was a child my favourite thing about school was...
- The thing that I disliked about school was...
- My typical school day looked like this:...

2. Match the questions to the correct answers.

[Make sure that after completing the task, students understand the words and phrases in bold.]

- a) Do you know any people who were **homeschooled**? 7
 - b) Did you spend much time with your **peers** when you went to school? 2
 - c) Are home schools **legal** in your country? 5
 - d) How could schools help children who feel **isolated** from their classmates? 3
 - e) Which is better: to **study at your own pace** or with your classmates? 1
 - f) What are some **drawbacks** of giving homework to students? 4
 - g) What are some problems that **conventional schools** have? 6
 - h) How can we use technology to make sure all students have **opportunities** to learn? 8
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- 1) To properly understand something, you need to do it as slowly or fast as you like.
 - 2) I am an extrovert, so I had many friends at school, and we always did fun things.
 - 3) They could organize some team-building events to help students make friends. Psychological support can help, too.
 - 4) When children come home, they should spend time with family or friends.
 - 5) No, they are not. All kids have to go to school, they can't receive education at home.
 - 6) Teachers don't give enough attention to students. Also, many schools don't have enough equipment and the buildings are quite old.
 - 7) Yes, one of my friends studied at home.
 - 8) Online learning can help students who live a long way from a school because they can attend virtual lessons without worrying about how to get to school.

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3. Discuss the questions in ex. 2.

4. Complete the US statistics with one of the two options: 'homeschooled students' or 'students from conventional schools'.

- a) In standard tests, **homeschooled students** get 15 to 30% more points than **students from conventional schools**.
- b) 67% of **homeschooled students** graduate from university, while the number of **students from conventional schools** who complete higher education is 57.5%.

5. Discuss the questions.

- Are you surprised by the facts in ex. 4?
- Do they prove that homeschooling is better than conventional schooling?

6. Watch a [video](https://youtu.be/aG4B273EhyI) [https://youtu.be/aG4B273EhyI] and answer the questions.

- a) What is special about the McCullough family? **The children from this family don't go to a conventional school because they are homeschooled.**
- b) How would you describe Andrew's and Kaity's school day? **Possible answer: It is quite fun: they study interesting things, such as art, chemistry and nature. They also do activities with other homeschooled children.**

7. Watch the [video](https://youtu.be/aG4B273EhyI) again. Correct the statements to make them true.

- a) All the subjects that Kaity and Andrew study are different from what students have in conventional schools. **They study Art Appreciation, Literature and Spelling, World Geography, Nature and Chemistry.**
[00:21]
- b) Andrew thinks that the biggest plus of homeschooling is spending time with his family. **He thinks that the biggest advantage is that he can learn at his own pace.** [00:55]
- c) Kristi doesn't give grades to her children. **She keeps a detailed gradebook.**
[01:23]



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- d) Kaity believes that homeschooled children are often lonely. *She thinks that homeschooled children spend enough time with peers and are good at being social. [02:03]*
- e) When Kaity and Andrew are older, they want to continue homeschool education. *They want to go to conventional high school and university. [02:33]*

8. Discuss the questions.

- Kristi said that homeschooling is a great opportunity for a family to be together. Do you agree with her?
- Why might a parent decide to homeschool their child? *Possible answers: to protect them, to give them more knowledge than schools can, to train them for a job, etc.*
- Would you ever homeschool your children?
- Would you prefer to have been homeschooled? Would your life be different?

9. Choose a number from 1 to 10. You will be given a topic to talk about.

- 1) *You should be rich and highly educated to homeschool your child.*
- 2) *Homeschooled children can't be successful because they are isolated from real-life challenges.*
- 3) *Parents homeschool their children because they want to control everything in their lives.*
- 4) *Conventional schools are bad at giving students good quality education.*
- 5) *Parents are the best teachers.*
- 6) *Conventional schools kill children's creativity.*
- 7) *Homeschooling is better for small kids.*
- 8) *It can be dangerous to let all parents homeschool their children.*
- 9) *Children who are homeschooled are much more intelligent than their peers.*
- 10) *You need to be at home all the time to homeschool your child.*

10. List the advantages and disadvantages of these unconventional education ideas.

- Unschooling. Education happens in freedom: there are no tests, assignments or educational programmes at all.
- Hiring private tutors and teachers for homeschooling.
- Online education. Taking online courses instead of going to school.
- A child studies at home some days and at a conventional school some days.

[This worksheet includes an additional task that you can use as homework or revision. It's only available in the teacher's version of the worksheet. Print it and hand it out to your students.]

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Make four usual and four silly sentences using the vocabulary provided and one of the words in brackets. The sentences don't have to be true.

EXAMPLE: school (nut, artist, sharp, wrong, foot) – Some artists left school early to focus on their work.
The little squirrel goes to school to learn how to find, hide and crack nuts.

- conventional school (captain, dictionary, head, smart, glass)
- homeschooled (schedule, step, centre, activity, lesson)
- learn at one's own pace (fear, slow, pet, background, understand)
- opportunity (trainer, class, worker, course, guitar)
- peers (hill, social, surprise, well, cancel)
- isolated (playground, great, alone, highlight, develop)
- drawback (book, climb, portrait, ticket, teach)
- legal (sweat, calendar, country, normal, sail)

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